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A FEMALE ROBINSON CRUSOE.

Truth is very much stranger than fiction,

and a female Crusoe, belonging to a class in

society far different to that of a female in

England, young lady of fashion, was really

found on the island of St. Nicholas, off the southern coast of California,

where she appears to have been accidentally

abandoned, and to have spent the last

eighteen years of her life. The involuntary

recluses—we are sorry to have to speak of

her in the past tense, but she is no more—

was, according to a San Francisco newspaper,

an Indian woman, and her existence was

accidentally discovered by a man who had

landed on the island to look for others, and

who found her in a desperate state of im-

becation. But she soon took the track,

and during three years' periodical excursions

to the island he was unable to light

upon any further signs indicating the

whereabouts of the "lunatic." At length

one of the party who accompanied him

came suddenly on the object of their search,

who was found in a kind of kral or

concealed house built of brushwood, about

five feet high and six feet in diameter, with

a small lateral opening. The Indian Miss

Crusoe was attired in a garment made from

the skin of the "kral," a species of deer, and

unwisely clad that can neither walk

nor fly. It was a most clumsy costume,

and reached nearly to her ankles when she

stood erect. Wholly ignorant of the

other hunters she was sitting cross-legged,

engaged in the usual but slightly uncom-

mon occupation of skinning and flubber

with a rude knife fashioned from a piece

of iron hoop driven into a piece of wood.

She had no head-gear beyond a great shock

of matted hair, which, probably

owing to its constant exposure to the

sun and the weather, had ac-

quired a yellowish-brown hue, and which

was short as though the ends had rotted

away. Her Indian name was almost al-

ways black-and-white, and the unusual

phenomenon of Miss Crusoe suggests a cheap

and efficacious recipe for changing a brown

into a blonde, and for restoring the hair

to its natural color. Only the patient will

A FEMALE ROBINSON CRUSOE.

Truth is very much stranger than fiction, and a female Crusoe, belonging to a class in society far different to that assumed by an English young lady of fashion, has recently been really discovered on the island of San Nicolas, off the southern coast of California, where she appears to have been accidentally abandoned, and to have spent the last eighteen years of her life. The involuntary recluse—we are sorry to have to speak of her in the past tense, but she is no more—was, according to a San Francisco newspaper, an Indian woman, and her existence was accidentally discovered by a man who had landed on the island to hunt for otters, and who found human footprints deeply imbedded in the soil. But he soon lost the track, and during three years' periodical excursions to the island he was unable to light upon any farther signs indicating the whereabouts of the "human." At length one of the party who accompanied him came suddenly on the object of their search, who was found in a kind of arched or circular enclosure built of brushwood, about five feet high and six feet in diameter, with

five feet high and six feet in diameter, with a small lateral opening. The Indian Miss Crusoe was attired in a garment made from the skins of the "shag," a species of ugly and unwisely duck that can neither walk nor fly. It was a most clumsy costume, and reached nearly to her ankles when she stood erect. When "interviewed" by the other hunters she was sitting cross-legged, engaged in the useful but slightly malodorous occupation of skinning seal blubber with a rude knife fashioned from a piece of iron hoop driven into a piece of wood. She had no head-gear beyond a great shock of matted hair, which, probably owing to its constant exposure to the sun and the weather, had assumed a yellowish-brown hue, and which was short, as though the ends had rotted away. Now, Indians are almost always black-haired, and the comical phenomena of Miss Crusoe suggests a cheap and efficacious recipe for changing a brunette into a blonde, and shortening the hair without cutting it. Only the patient will have to go about bareheaded until the benignant sun turns the dark locks, auburn and singes the ends. There were some half-wild dogs on the island, and a few of these animals kept near the head of the female

other dogs in the kitchen, and a few of these animals kept near the knee of the female Crusoe, and seemed to regard her as their mistress. As for her diet, she appears to have lived chiefly on the cabbage-like plant known to the Californians as "palo verde," also on a root called "coronilla." This will be pleasant news for the vegetarians; but the gratification of the Food Reform Society will be lessened when it is added that Miss Crusoe was much addicted to the consumption of seal blubber. She was also found to be in possession of a rude apparatus for catching shell fish, and her stock of string fishing lines, made from the sinews of seals, seemed to point to her having occasionally pursued deep sea fishing. Her countenance is described as pleasing, her features as regular, her complexion fairer, and her form more symmetrical than those of the Indian women in the mainland. Perhaps she was not an Indian after all; but a Saratoga belle who had repented of her watering-place levities, and taken refuge in the solitude, where she had remained until all faculty of articulate speech had departed from her. It must be remembered that, unlike the original Robinson, she had no parrot, and consequently no facilities for conversational practice. Civilization is

parrot, and consequently no conversation practice. Civilization is but skin deep; and it is astonishing in how brief a time Man, left to himself, will begin to run about on all fours and back. The female *Cruise* of San Nicolas did not bark, it is true; but she did not seem to understand any of the Indian dialects spoken in California, and did not volunteer any gibberish. She was a kind of Californian *Fenella*, for although substantially mute, she enjoyed a wonderful faculty for conversing by signs. She retained all her teeth, but they were worn low, probably owing to her chewing tough articles of food. As regards the delicate question of her age, her years, like those of Don Quixote, to all appearance "bordered on the fifties;" but she bowed to all who approached her, and greeted them with a smile. She must have been a *Saratoga Belle* who had lost her speech, but who had retained the sweetness and grace of her manners.

Poor Miss Robinson *Cruise*! The Californian bear hunters had much better have left her in her brushwood "ranch," on the Island of San Nicolas, contentedly cross-legged, wearing her simple robe of sheep-skin, and supporting existence on a simple diet of cabbage plant, coveys, and coal

and of strange pain, sorrow, and
blubber. She lively accompanied her dis-
cussers to their vessel, and at once won their
attention by the modesty and decorum of
her demeanour. She exhibited singular
dexterity in making vessels for holding
water out of grass and asphaltum, in both
of which San Nicolas is very prolific; and
she also seemed to recognize various ap-
plications of civilization. • basket
probably, or possibly a fryingpan. A
great future awaited her. Arrived at San
Francisco, she would have been fêted and
exposed, and ere long a guest of the ubi-
quitous Piousness T. Barnum would have
arrived on the scene; and the female Cruise
might have been waited to that Great
Temple of Showmanship, the American
Museum at New York, there to hold lessons
in the Hall made famous by the memorials
of the Minnow, the Angel Fish from Mex-
ico, the Nova Scotia Quarters, the Albin-
Family, Washington's Nurse, and the Wood-
ly Horse. Who knows but that in process
of time, the female Cruise from the Pacific
might not have made her appearance in
London, and delighted crowded audiences
by skimming seal blubber, making water jars
from grass and asphalt, and expressing by
a series of animated signs, her opinions on
the Eastern Question? We have been for-
-

ed with the presence of the Mottentot Venus; the Bearded Lady, Miss Julia Pastress; the stout Lady, Mrs. Armitage; the Two-headed Nightingale, the Aztec children, General Tom Thumb, Minnie Warren and Commodore Nutt; but indeed a female Crusoe would have been indeed, a rarity. She would have been as popular amongst us as Peter the Wild Boy was in the reign of George I., and as poor Kasper Hauser might have been had he escaped assassination. But this was not to be. Seven weeks after her arrival on the Californian mainland the poor female Crusoe sickened and died, partly it is stated, from the effects of a fall, and partly through an indigestion brought on by eating fruits and vegetables. She have pined for her simple menu of "palo santo" and "cocconite," varied by seal blubber; and the circumstances of the fruits and vegetables of California having conduced to her dissolution, must additionally lessen the complacency of the Food Reform Society. A course of lentils might have saved her, but there were none seemingly at hand. She had been religiously baptized by Padre Gonzalez, the superior of the mission of Santa Barbara; and that esteemed ecclesiastic has forwarded the female Crusoe's dress of dog-skins and her baskets and implements to the Museum of the Propaganda at Rome. It is a pity that she did not recover her speech, if only for a few minutes, before she passed away. She might have told the world whether she was really an Indian squaw, or a Saratoga belle disgusted with and retired from Vanity Fair.—*London Telegraph.*
